INDIA INSIGHT LAB · THEMATIC REPORTS

Understanding Urban India

Population density, housing, transport, air quality and energy in India's cities, read as one story.

5	36	8	1951–2036
CHAPTERS	INDICATORS	WITH STATE DATA	PERIOD COVERED

Generated 21 Aug 2026 · assembled from 31 sources
This PDF is a snapshot. Indicators are revised as their sources publish; indiainsightlab.com always carries the current figures.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report assembles 36 indicators across 5 chapters, drawn from 31 sources and covering 1951–2036.

Of those indicators, 8 carry state-level detail and can be mapped across India's states. The remaining 28 are published at national level only by their source, and are shown here as national series without a sub-national breakdown.

> **Coverage limits.** This report contains no district- or city-level figures. Comparable district data is not currently integrated into India Insight Lab, and no value here has been estimated, interpolated or carried down from a higher geography to fill that gap. Where a number is absent, it is absent.

KEY FINDINGS

Each finding below is computed directly from the state values in this report — the highest and lowest recorded state for that indicator. None are authored interpretations.

1 **Slum population share by state**

Ranges from 24.0% in Andhra Pradesh to 4.9% in Kerala — a spread of 19.1% across the 15 states reported.

Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum

2

Forest cover by state

Ranges from 85.4% in Mizoram to 3.6% in Haryana — a spread of 81.8% across the 8 states reported.

India State of Forest Report, Forest Survey of India

CHAPTER 1

Urban development & housing

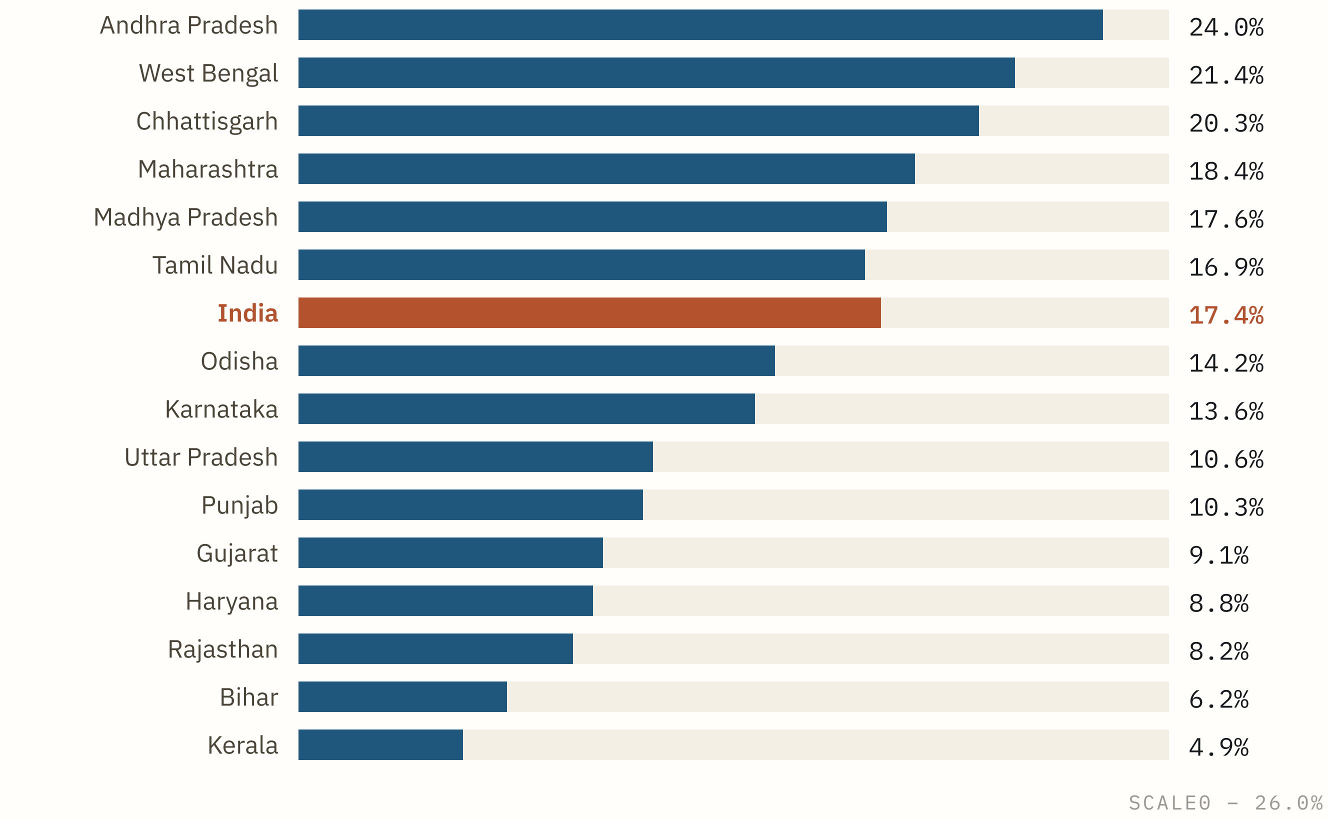
1 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 1.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 1.1 RANKED BARS

Slum population share by state

Share of a state's urban population enumerated in Census-notified or recognised slums.



Source: Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum

This is the last Census-based slum count available — no Census has been held since 2011, so growth in informal settlements over the past decade is not captured here. Definitions vary by state (notified, recognised and identified slums), which limits strict comparability.

> Highest: **Andhra Pradesh** at 24.0%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 4.9%.

Source: Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum Coverage: 2011 Updated: 11 Jan 2026

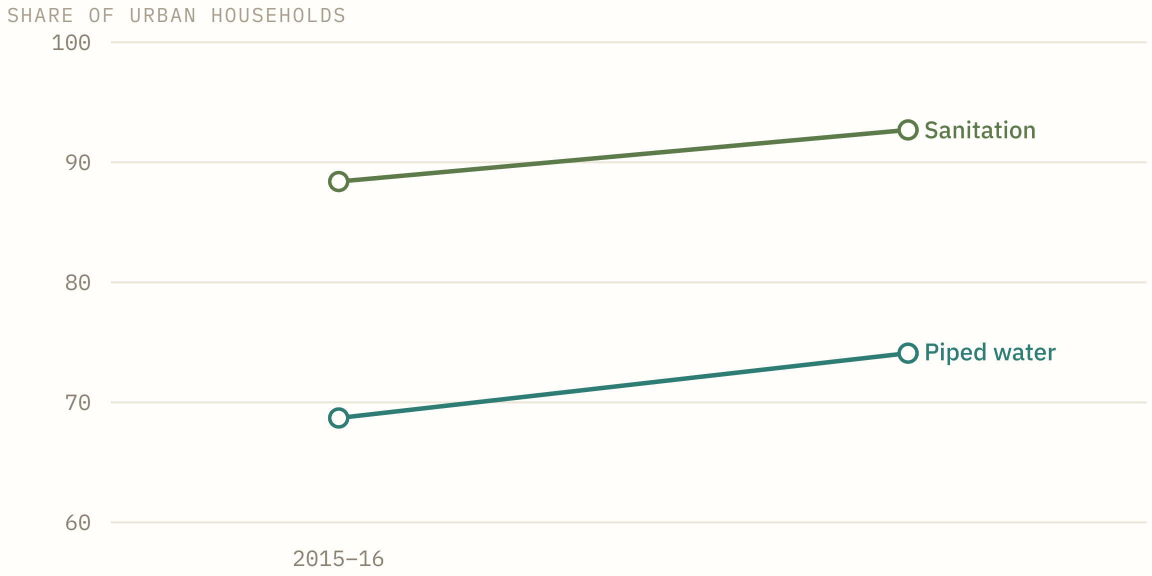
FIGURE 1.2 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.2

SLOPE CHART

Urban piped water and sanitation access

Share of urban households with piped water on premises, and with improved, unshared sanitation.



Piped water on premises — Improved, unshared sanitation

> Both measures rose over the two NFHS rounds, with the Swachh Bharat Mission's urban push likely behind most of the sanitation gain. "Piped on premises" excludes households relying on public taps or tankers even where those are the piped source.

Source: NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, MoHFW

Both series improved between NFHS rounds. "Piped on premises" is stricter than "access to an improved water source" — it excludes households that rely on public taps, tankers or neighbours' connections even if the underlying source is piped.

Source: NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, MoHFW Coverage: 2015–16 to 2019–21 Updated: 11 Jan 2026

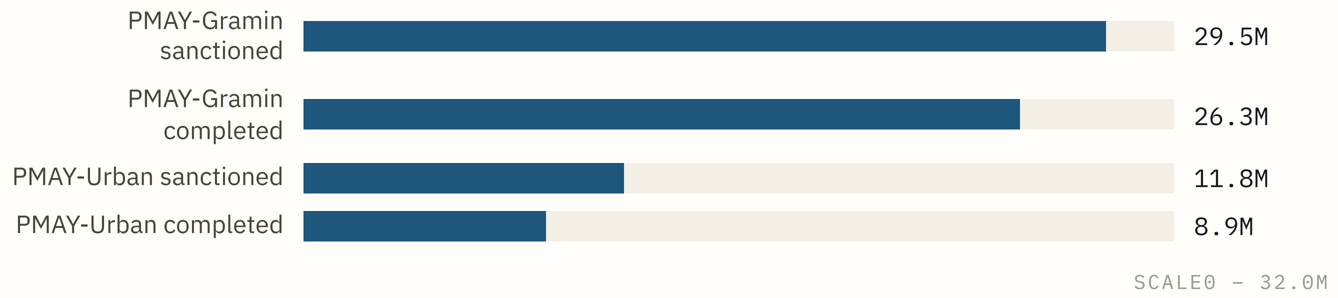
FIGURE 1.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.3

RANKED BARS

PMAY housing progress

Houses sanctioned versus completed under the rural and urban Housing for All schemes.



Source: Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana dashboards, MoHUA & MoRD

The rural scheme (PMAY-Gramin) is closer to its sanctioned target than the urban scheme (PMAY-Urban), where land acquisition and construction timelines run longer. “Completed” means handed over to the beneficiary, not merely under construction.

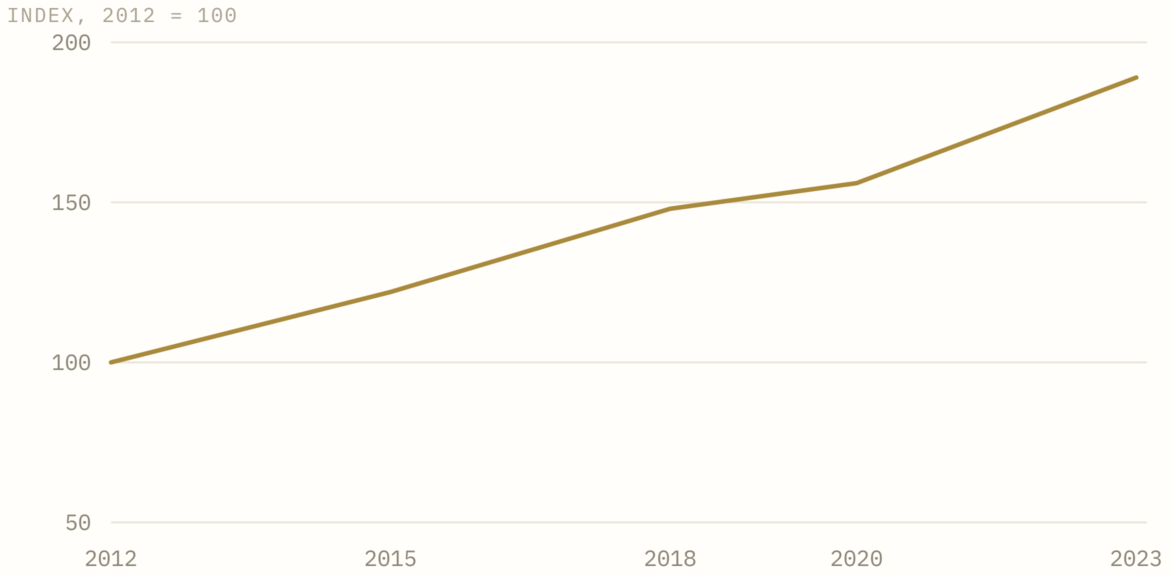
Source: Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana dashboards, MoHUA & MoRD Coverage: Cumulative to 2025 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 1.4 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.4 LINE CHART

Night-time light intensity

Indexed satellite-measured night-time light intensity, a proxy for economic and urban activity.



> Indexed from satellite VIIRS-DNB night-time light composites, a widely used proxy for regional economic activity where official sub-national GDP data lags or is unavailable. This is a research-derived composite, not an official government statistic — treat the trend as indicative rather than precise.

Source: VIIRS-DNB satellite composites, research literature

Night-time lights are used by researchers as a fast, sub-national proxy for economic growth where official data is thin or delayed. It captures electrified activity, not output directly, so it can overstate growth in areas that simply gained grid access rather than economic output.

Source: VIIRS-DNB satellite composites, research literature Coverage: 2012–2023 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

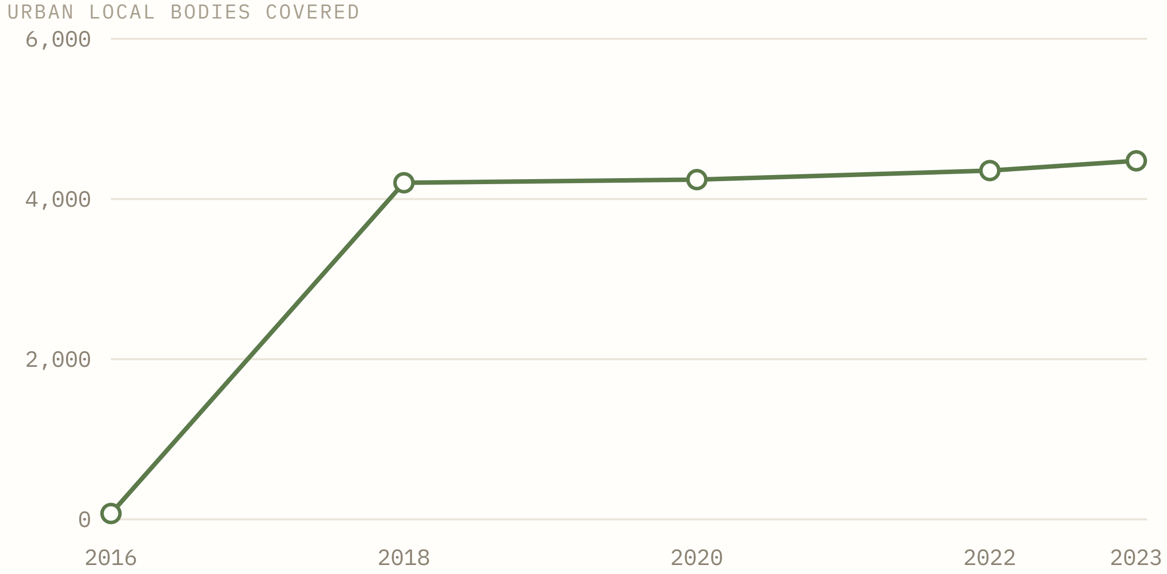
FIGURE 1.5 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.5

LINE CHART

Swachh Survekshan coverage

Number of cities and urban local bodies covered by India’s annual cleanliness survey.



> Swachh Survekshan grew from 73 cities in its first edition to nearly every urban local body in the country within a decade, making it the world’s largest urban cleanliness survey by participant count. Coverage growth, not score, is shown here — city rankings and scoring methodology have both changed across editions, which limits year-on-year score comparability.

Source: Swachh Survekshan, MoHUA

The survey has become close to universal across urban India, which is itself a policy achievement independent of any city’s score. Scoring methodology and weightings have changed across editions, so a city’s rank in different years is not a clean apples-to-apples comparison.

Source: Swachh Survekshan, MoHUA Coverage: 2016–2023 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 1.6 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.6

RANKED BARS

AMRUT water and sewerage connections

Household tap and sewer/septage connections provided under AMRUT's first phase.

Source: Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, MoHUA

AMRUT 1.0 fell short of its full connection targets by its 2021 close; AMRUT 2.0 (launched 2021) aims at universal coverage. Sewerage lagged water supply throughout the scheme, reflecting the higher cost and longer build time of underground network projects.

Source: Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, MoHUA Coverage: 2015–2021 (AMRUT 1.0)

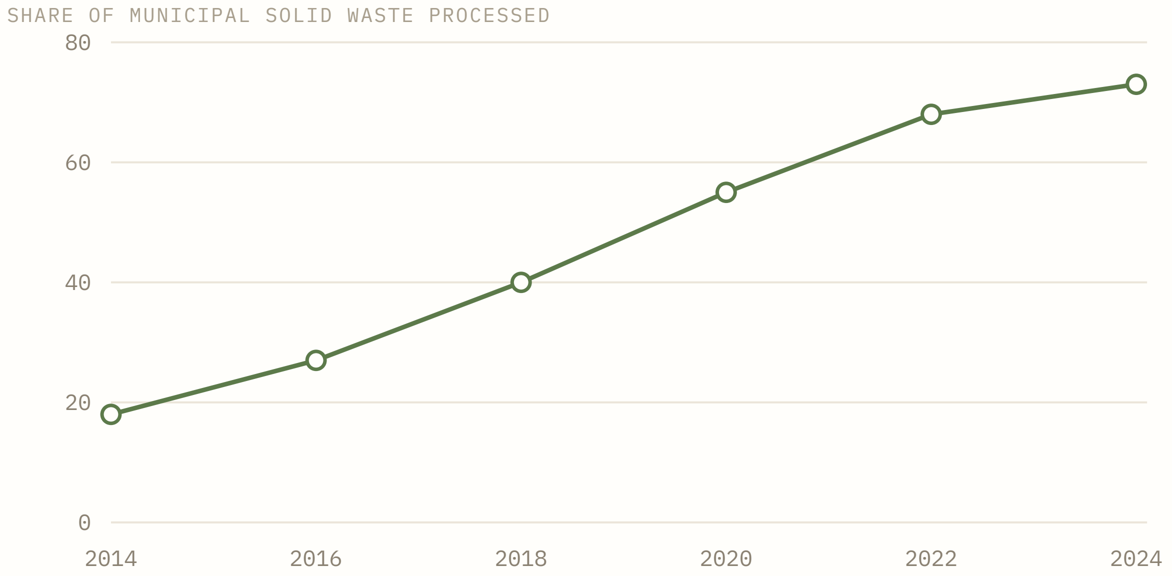
Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 1.7 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.7 LINE CHART

Municipal solid waste processing

Share of India's municipal solid waste that is scientifically processed rather than dumped.



Processing capacity has grown roughly fourfold under the Swachh Bharat Mission, though this tracks capacity utilisation rather than a direct daily audit — actual processing rates vary widely by city, and total waste generation has also grown as urban population and consumption rose.

Source: Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban dashboard, MoHUA

Processing capacity has grown roughly fourfold since 2014, but total waste generation has also risen with urban population and consumption growth — a rising processed share does not necessarily mean a falling absolute quantity dumped in landfills.

Source: Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban dashboard, MoHUA Coverage: 2014–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

CHAPTER 2

Transport & mobility

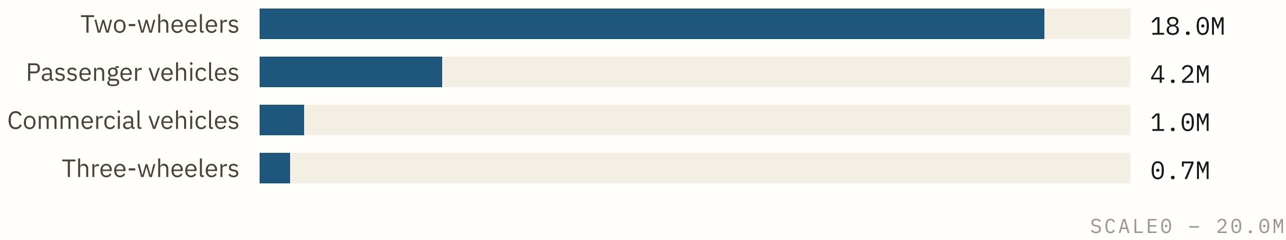
All 4 indicators in this chapter are published at national level only. No state breakdown is available from the sources used.

FIGURE 2.1 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 2.1 RANKED BARS

New vehicle registrations by category

New vehicles registered nationally in FY2023–24, by category.



Source: Vahan Dashboard, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways

Two-wheelers dominate India's vehicle fleet by a wide margin — more than four times passenger vehicle registrations. Vahan records registrations, not sales, so figures can lag manufacturer-reported sales by weeks.

Source: Vahan Dashboard, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways Coverage: 2023–24 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

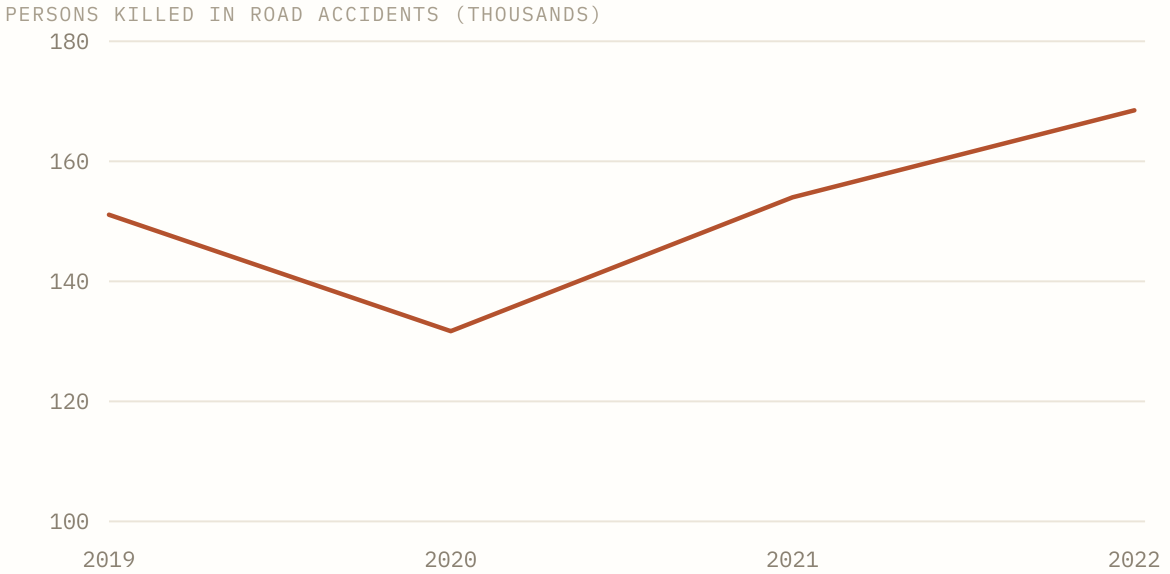
FIGURE 2.2 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 2.2

LINE CHART

Road accident deaths

Annual deaths from road traffic accidents, national total.



> 2022 recorded the highest annual road accident toll on record, despite fewer total accidents than pre-pandemic years — average crash severity has risen.

Source: ‘Road Accidents in India’, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways

2022 was the deadliest year on record even though reported accident counts were below 2019 levels — severity per crash has risen, partly reflecting more high-speed corridors. State reporting definitions vary, which limits comparability across states more than across years nationally.

Source: ‘Road Accidents in India’, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways Coverage: 2019–2022

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

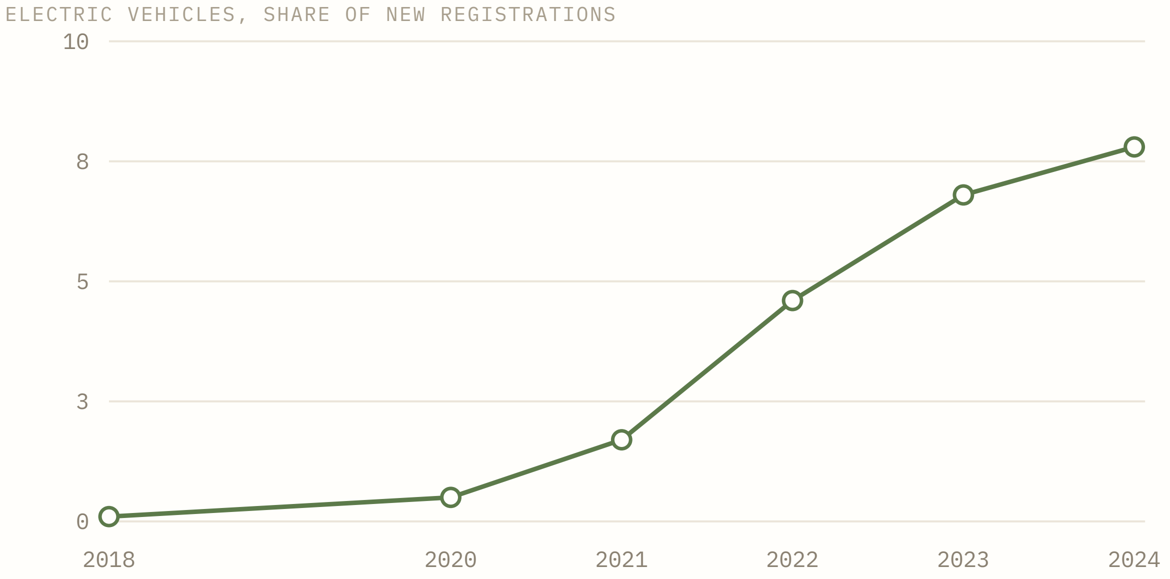
FIGURE 2.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 2.3

LINE CHART

Electric vehicle share of new registrations

Electric vehicles as a share of all new vehicle registrations, nationally.



> Electric two-wheelers and three-wheelers make up most of this growth; electric cars remain a small single-digit share of new passenger vehicle sales. FAME-II and state EV subsidies both influenced the steepest years of growth.

Source: Vahan Dashboard, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways

Electric two- and three-wheelers drive nearly all of this growth; electric passenger cars remain a small single-digit share of new car sales. Growth accelerated sharply after FAME-II and state-level EV subsidies took effect.

Source: Vahan Dashboard, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways Coverage: 2018–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

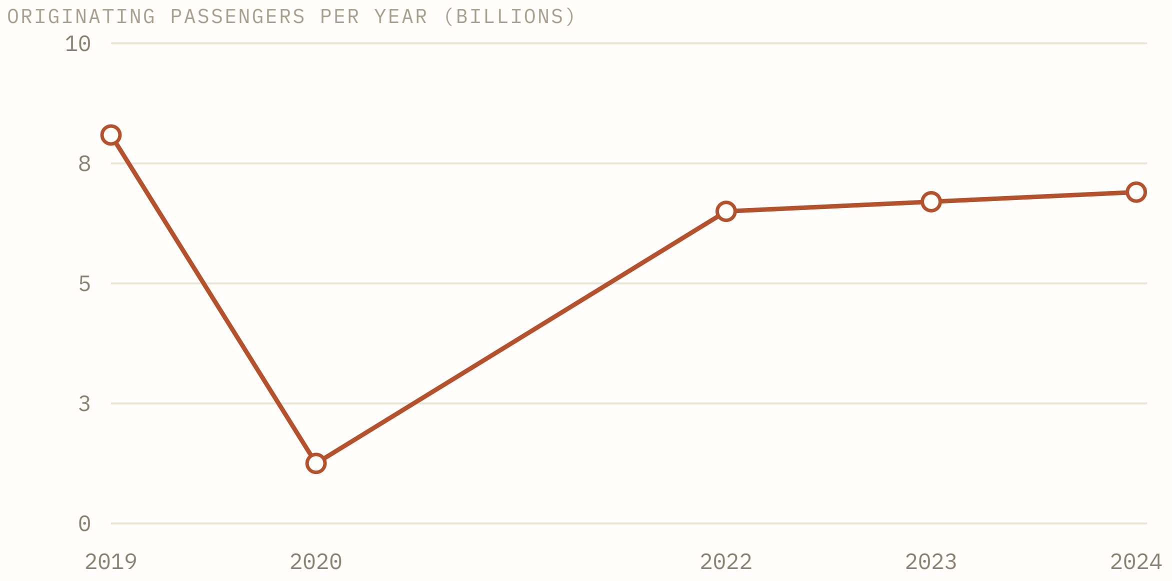
FIGURE 2.4 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 2.4

LINE CHART

Railway passenger volume

Originating passengers carried by Indian Railways, annually.



> The 2020–21 collapse reflects pandemic service suspensions; ridership has recovered most, but not all, of its pre-pandemic level as some short-distance trips shifted permanently to road and personal vehicles.

Source: Indian Railways Yearbook, Ministry of Railways

The 2020–21 collapse reflects pandemic service suspensions. Ridership has recovered most, though not all, of its pre-pandemic level — some short-distance trips appear to have shifted permanently to road and personal vehicles.

Source: Indian Railways Yearbook, Ministry of Railways Coverage: 2019–20 to 2023–24 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

CHAPTER 3

Population & demography

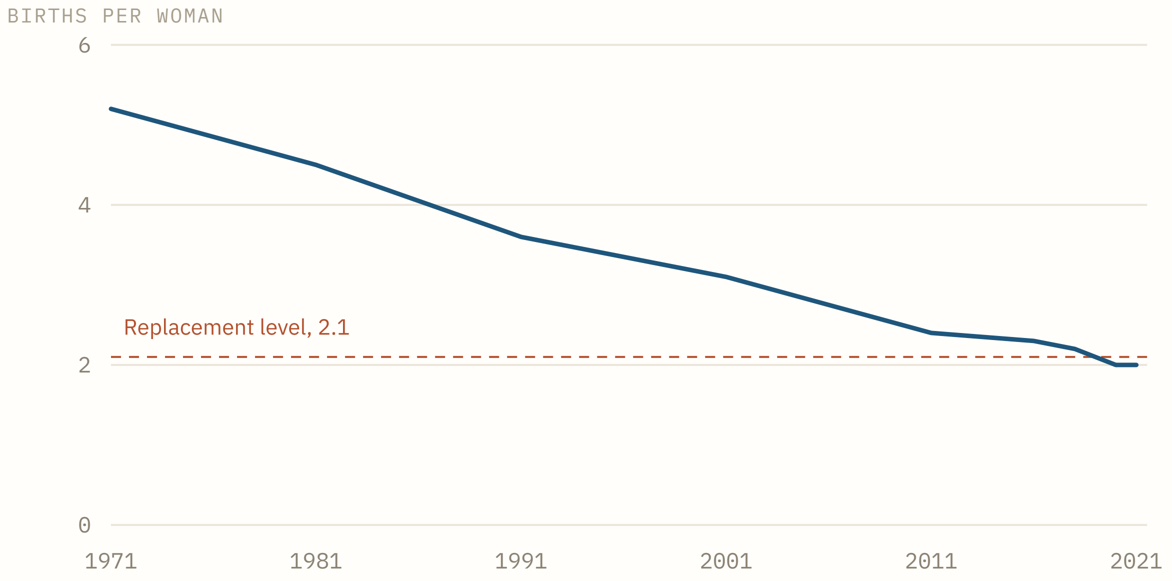
4 of 10 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 3.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 3.1 LINE CHART

Total fertility rate

Births per woman, national series. The dashed line marks the replacement level of 2.1.



Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI

The total fertility rate is the number of children a woman would bear if she experienced current age-specific fertility rates throughout her reproductive life. We splice decennial Census-based estimates to 1991 with the annual Sample Registration System thereafter; NFHS rounds are shown where they differ by more than 0.1.

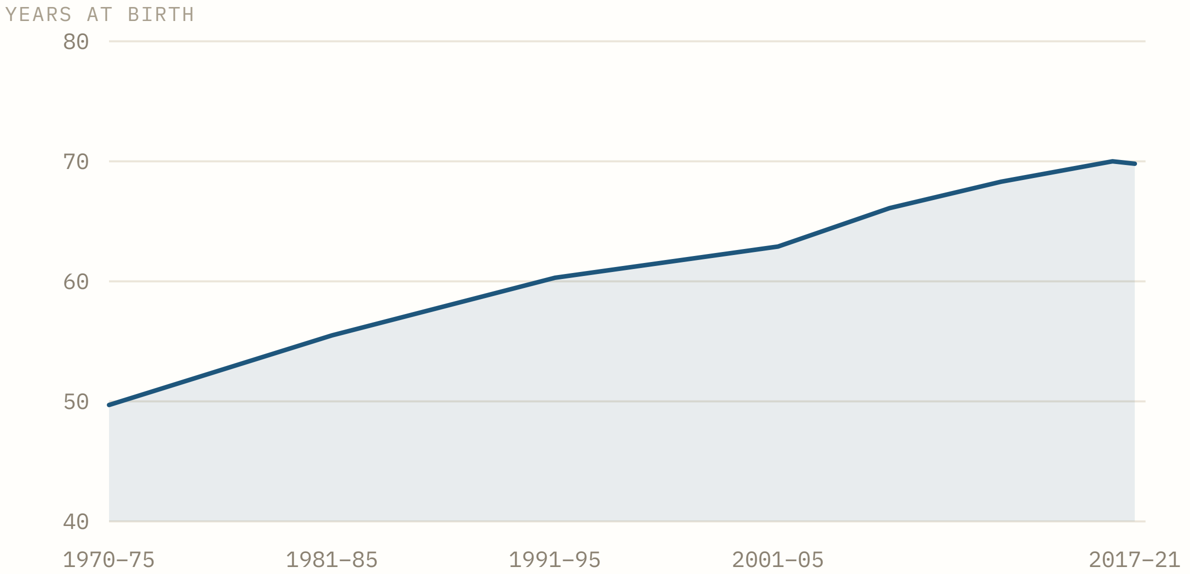
Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI Coverage: 1971–2023 Updated: 18 Jul 2026

FIGURE 3.2 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 3.2 AREA CHART

Life expectancy at birth

Period life expectancy at birth, India, five-year SRS estimates.



Source: SRS Abridged Life Tables 2017–21, RGI

Period life expectancy at birth assumes a newborn experiences current mortality rates at every age for life. It is not a forecast of any individual cohort. The 2021 fall is real and reflects pandemic excess mortality; estimates of its size still vary across sources by several years.

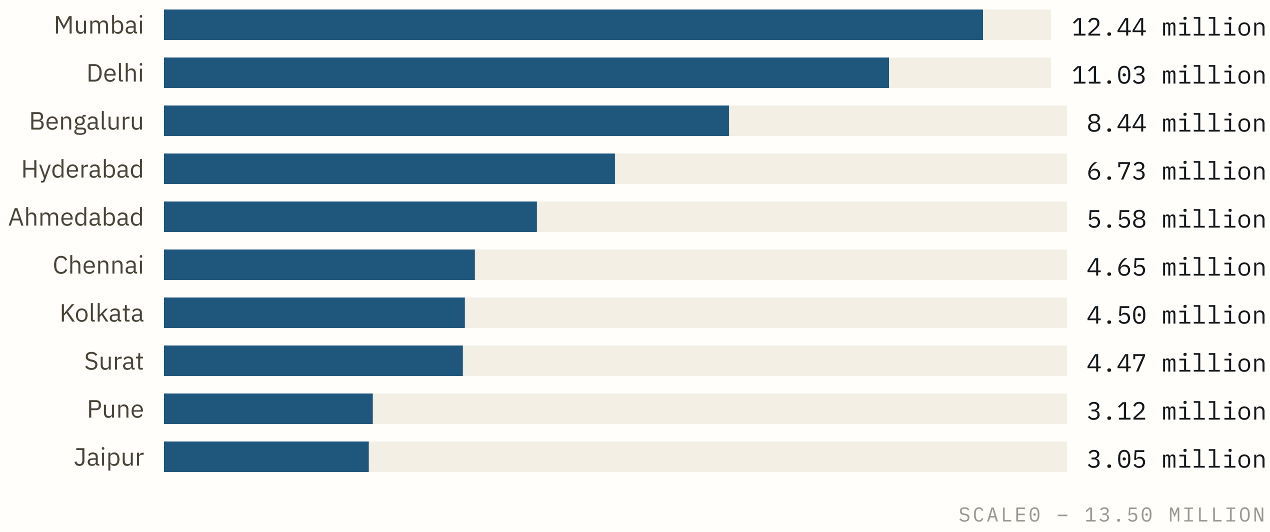
Source: SRS Abridged Life Tables 2017–21, RGI Coverage: 1970–75 to 2017–21 Updated: 18 Jul 2026

FIGURE 3.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 3.3 RANKED BARS

Ten largest cities by population

Population within municipal limits (city proper), excluding the wider urban agglomeration.



> City-proper population, within municipal limits — smaller than the wider urban agglomeration. Delhi's urban agglomeration (16.3 million) is roughly 48% larger than the city figure shown here.

Source: Census of India 2011

City-proper population excludes adjoining outgrowths and satellite towns, so it understates real metropolitan size — Delhi's urban agglomeration (16.3 million) is roughly 48% larger than its city-proper figure. We use city-proper because it is the more consistently defined boundary across cities.

Source: Census of India 2011 Coverage: 2011 Updated: 16 Aug 2026

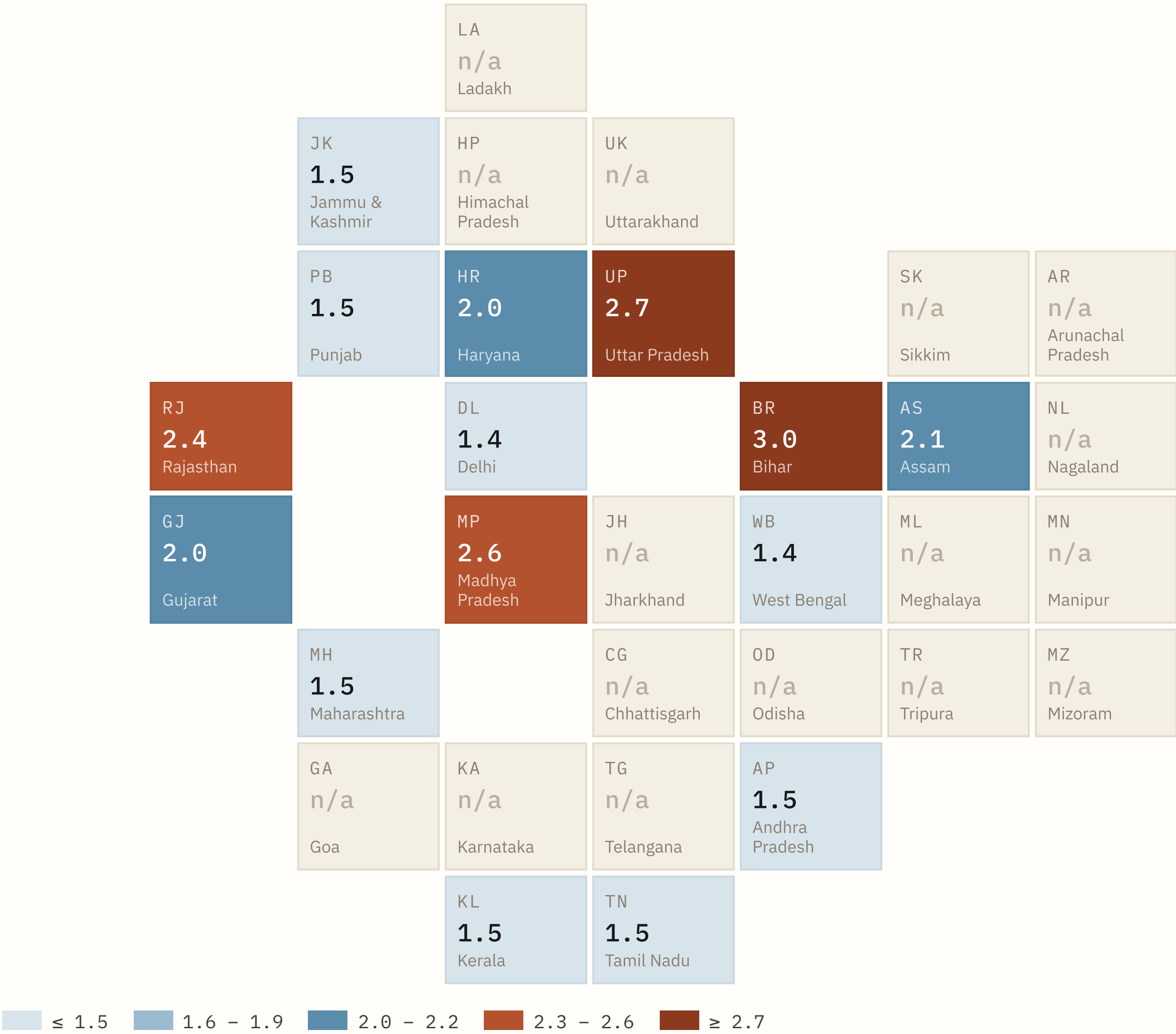
FIGURE 3.4 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 3.4

TILE MAP

Fertility rate — tile map

One equal-area tile per State and UT, positioned to approximate relative geography.



> Schematic tile map: one tile per State / UT, positioned to approximate relative geography. Tiles are equal-area, so no state is visually over-weighted by land mass.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI

A tile map removes the visual bias of land area: Rajasthan does not shout louder than Kerala. Tiles marked n/a are States and UTs for which the SRS 2021 report does not publish a separate TFR estimate.

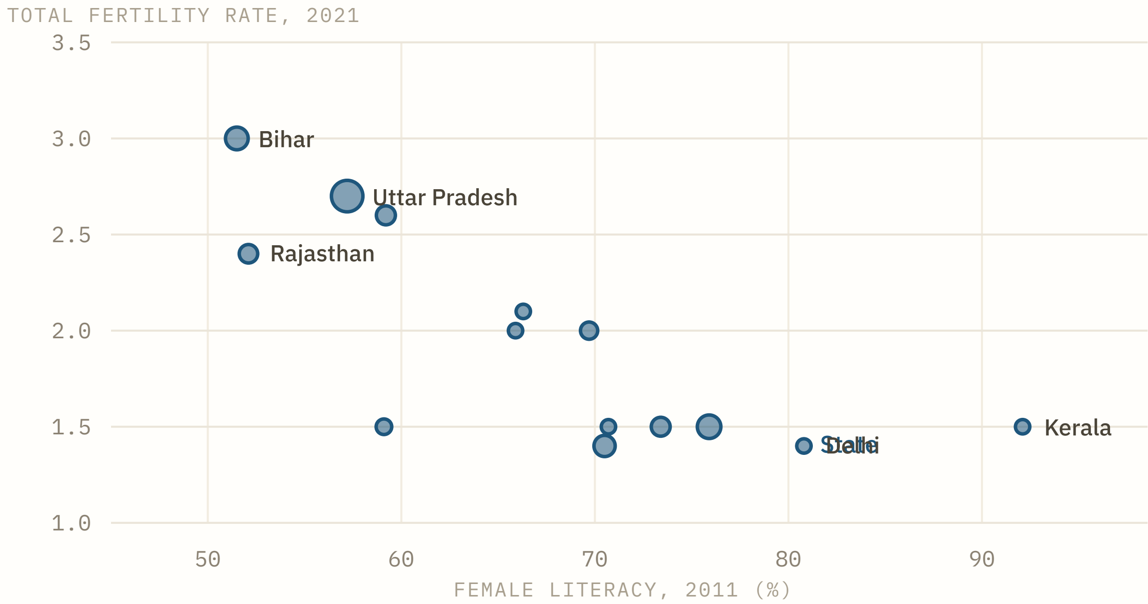
Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI Coverage: 2021 Updated: 18 Jul 2026

FIGURE 3.5 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 3.5 SCATTER

Female literacy against fertility

Each circle is a State. Horizontal: female literacy, 2011. Vertical: TFR, 2021. Area: population.



> Circle area is population. The relationship is strong and negative, but it is not proof of causation: literacy, age at marriage, child mortality and household income all move together.

Source: Census of India 2011; SRS 2021, RGI

The negative relationship is strong across States, but it is not evidence of causation on its own — literacy, age at marriage, child mortality and household income all move together. Read it as a description of the fertility map, not a mechanism.

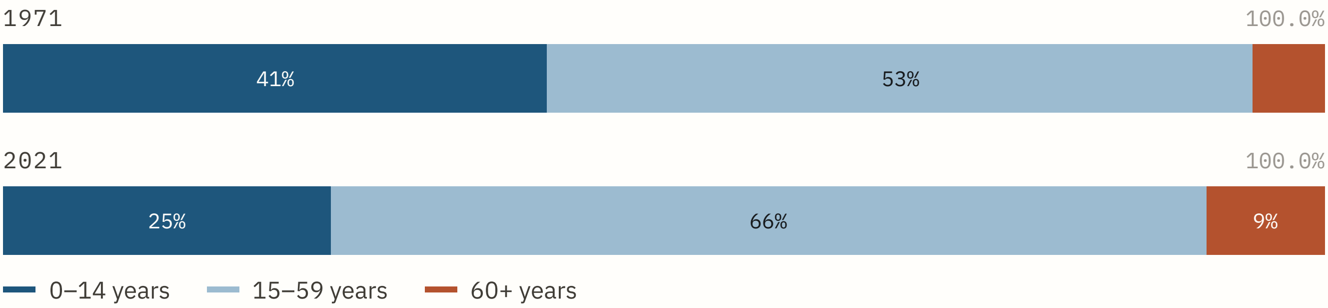
Source: Census of India 2011; SRS 2021, RGI Coverage: 2011 / 2021 Updated: 18 Jul 2026

FIGURE 3.6 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 3.6 COMPOSITION

Age composition of the population

Share of the population in three broad age groups, fifty years apart.



> The working-age share has risen 12.8 points in fifty years — the demographic dividend — while the 60+ share has not yet doubled. It does so in the next twenty-five years.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI

The 0–14 share fell from 41.2% to 24.8% between 1971 and 2021 while the working-age share rose to 66.2%. That gap is the demographic dividend; it closes as the 60+ share, now 9.0%, roughly doubles by 2050.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI   Coverage: 1971 and 2021   Updated: 18 Jul 2026

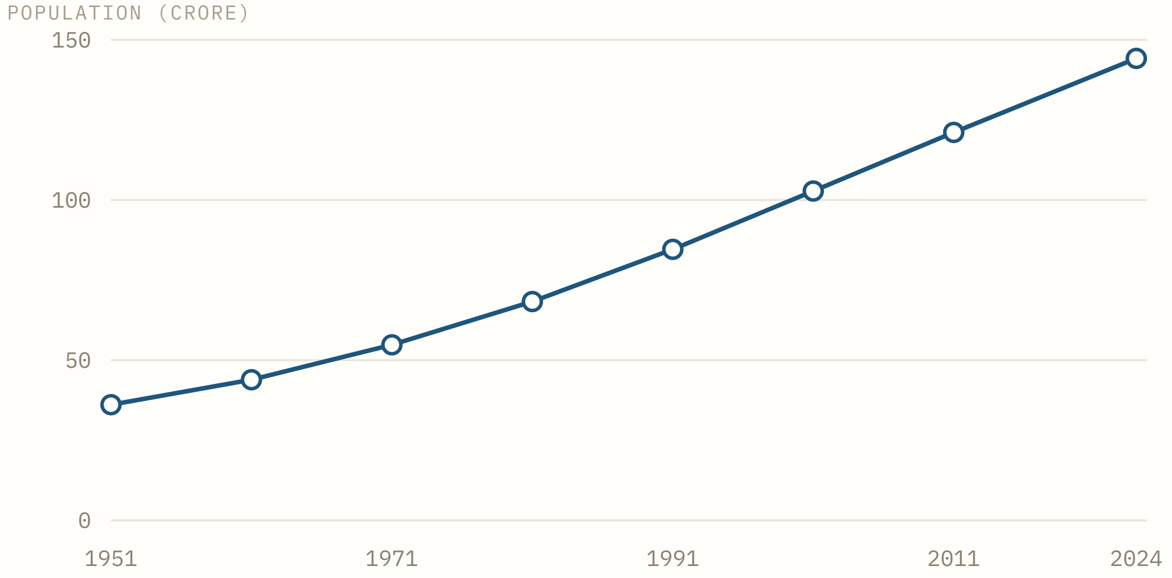
FIGURE 3.7 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 3.7

LINE CHART

Total population and density

India’s total population by decade, alongside population density.



Density has risen in lockstep, from 117 persons/km² in 1951 to 382 in the 2011 Census and an estimated 480 today — India adds roughly one Australia’s worth of people every three years.

Source: Census of India; UN World Population Prospects

India crossed 1 billion people around 2000 and an estimated 1.44 billion by 2024, having overtaken China as the world’s most populous country in 2023. Density figures assume a fixed land area, so they track population growth almost exactly.

Source: Census of India; UN World Population Prospects Coverage: 1951–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

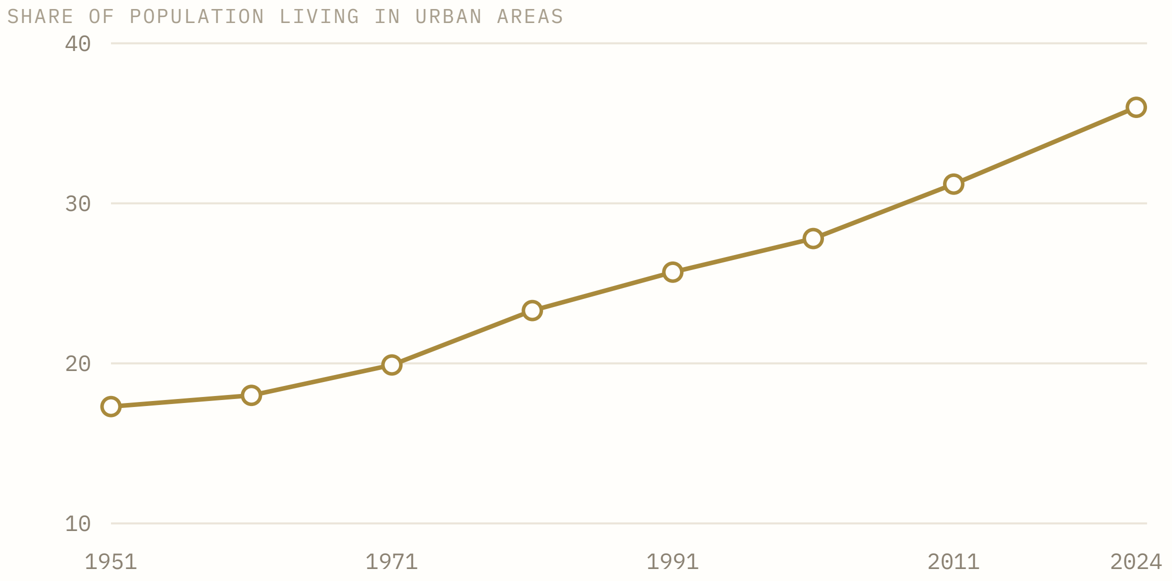
FIGURE 3.8 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 3.8

LINE CHART

Urbanisation rate

Share of India’s population living in urban areas, by decade.



> India urbanised more slowly than China or Indonesia over the same decades, which is part of why its cities are now catching up under significant infrastructure strain. The 2024 figure is a UN estimate; the next Census will provide the first official update since 2011.

Source: Census of India; UN World Urbanization Prospects

India’s urbanisation has been notably gradual compared to East Asian peers — a mixed blessing that avoided some of the informal-settlement crises seen elsewhere, but also means the next wave of urban growth, now underway, is arriving on infrastructure built for a smaller urban population.

Source: Census of India; UN World Urbanization Prospects Coverage: 1951–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

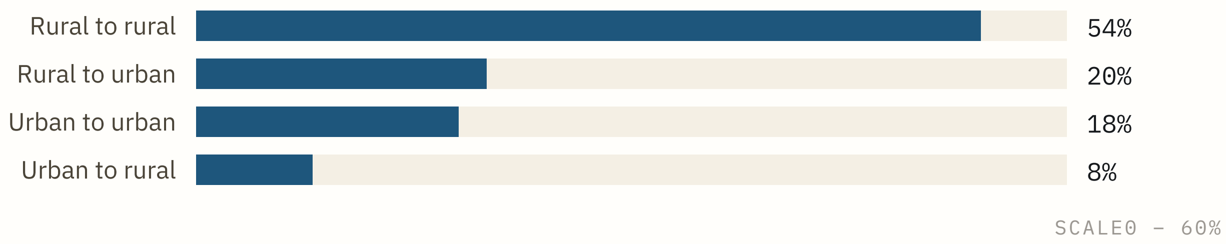
FIGURE 3.9 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 3.9

RANKED BARS

Internal migration streams

India's internal migrants by origin-destination stream.



Source: Census of India, D-series migration tables

Rural-to-rural migration, mostly marriage-related moves by women, is the largest stream by volume — rural-to-urban labour migration, the stream most associated with India's growth story, is actually the second largest, not the biggest.

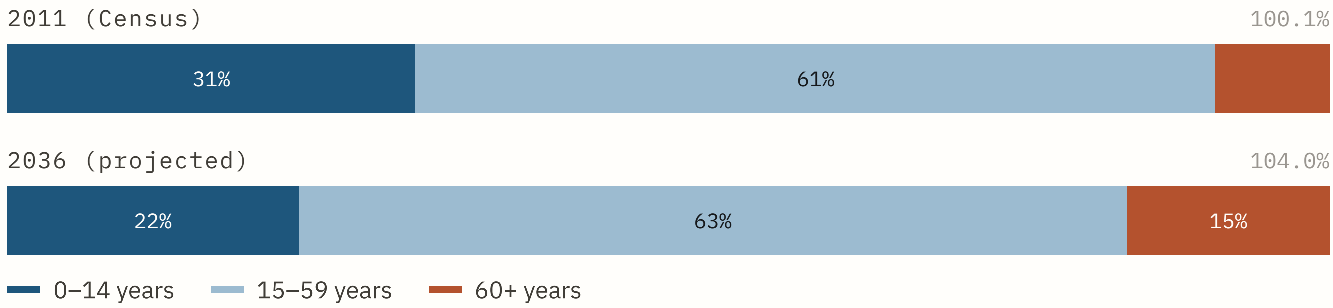
Source: Census of India, D-series migration tables Coverage: 2011 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 3.10 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 3.10 COMPOSITION

Future population by age group

Official government projection of India's age structure through 2036.



> From the Registrar General's official National Population Projections (2011–2036), not an ad hoc extrapolation. The 60+ share nearly doubles while the working-age share peaks and starts to plateau — the demographic dividend has a visible expiry date in this data.

Source: National Population Projections 2011–2036, Registrar General of India

This is RGI's own published projection, not an extrapolation built for this site. It shows the demographic dividend has a visible expiry date: the working-age share is projected to plateau around the mid-2030s as the 60+ share nearly doubles from its 2011 level.

Source: National Population Projections 2011–2036, Registrar General of India

Coverage: 2011 to 2036 (projected) Updated: 18 Aug 2026

CHAPTER 4

Climate & air quality

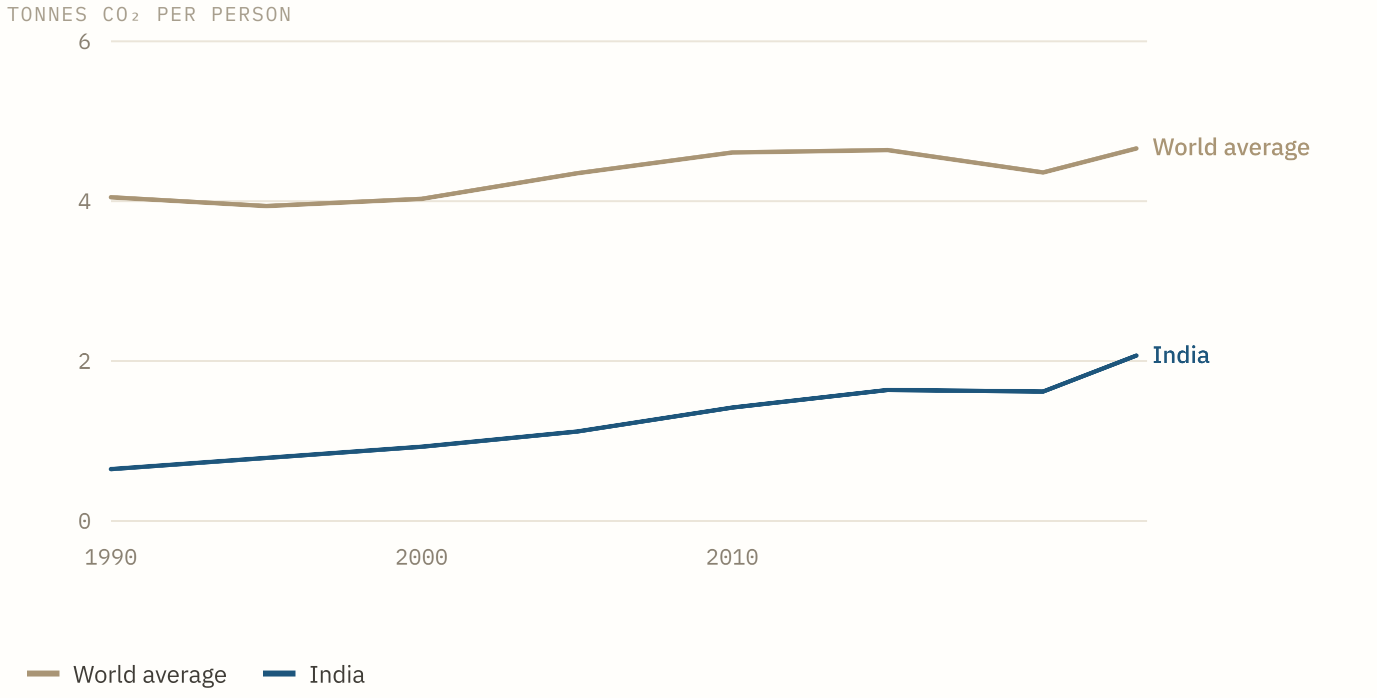
1 of 10 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 4.1 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.1 LINE CHART

CO_2 emissions per capita

Territorial emissions from fossil fuels and industry, per person.



Source: Global Carbon Budget

India is the third-largest emitter in absolute terms and among the lowest per person of any major economy — roughly 45 per cent of the world average. Cumulative emissions since 1850 are about 3 per cent of the global total.

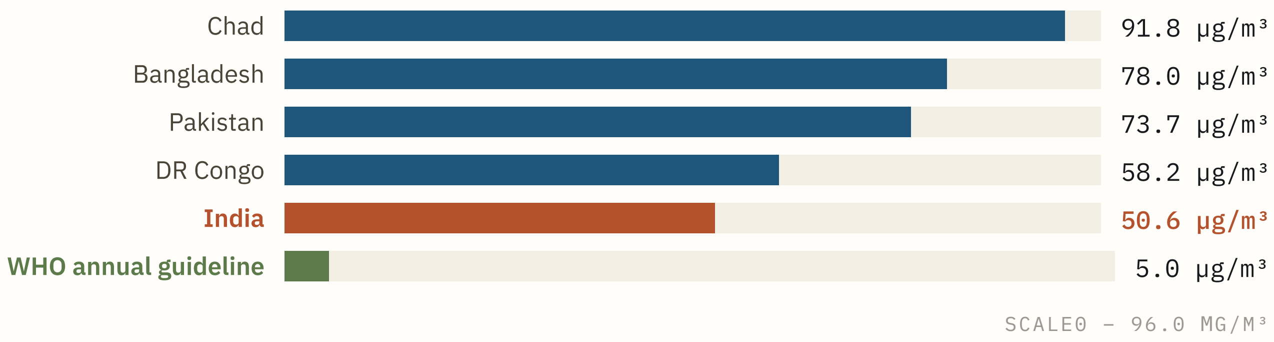
Source: Global Carbon Budget Coverage: 1990–2023 Updated: 14 Apr 2026

FIGURE 4.2 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.2 RANKED BARS

Annual mean PM2.5, most polluted countries

Population-weighted annual mean concentration. The WHO guideline is 5 $\mu g/m^3$.



> Population-weighted annual mean PM2.5, 2024. India ranked fifth of 138 countries and regions assessed; 74 of the world’s 100 most polluted settlements were Indian.

Source: IQAir World Air Quality Report 2024

Every city shown exceeds the WHO annual guideline of 5 $\mu g/m^3$, and all but one exceed India’s own standard of 40. Monitor coverage is uneven: much of central and eastern India has fewer than one continuous monitor per million people.

Source: IQAir World Air Quality Report 2024 Coverage: 2024 Updated: 14 Apr 2026

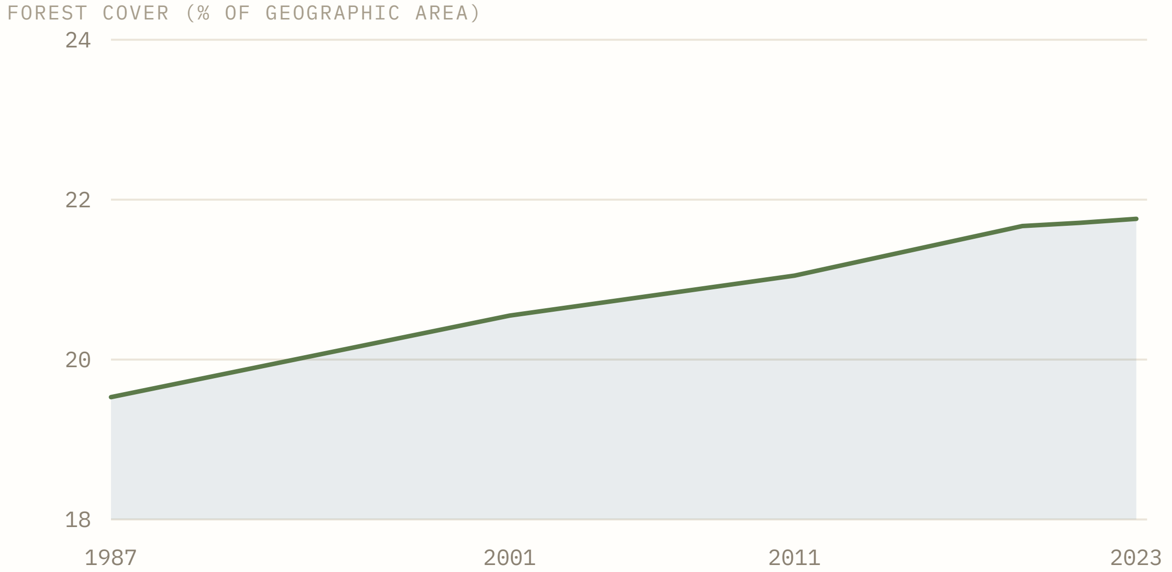
FIGURE 4.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.3

AREA CHART

Forest cover

Satellite-based forest cover assessment, biennial ISFR editions since 1987.



India State of Forest Report, Forest Survey of India, biennial satellite-based assessments since 1987. Forest cover (canopy density ≥10%) has risen slowly but steadily; it excludes orchard and plantation tree cover, which FSI records separately and which has grown faster.

Source: India State of Forest Report, Forest Survey of India

Forest cover has risen slowly but steadily, from 19.53% of geographic area in 1987 to 21.76% in 2023 — still short of the National Forest Policy target of 33%. The figure excludes orchard and plantation tree cover, tracked separately, which has grown faster than natural forest.

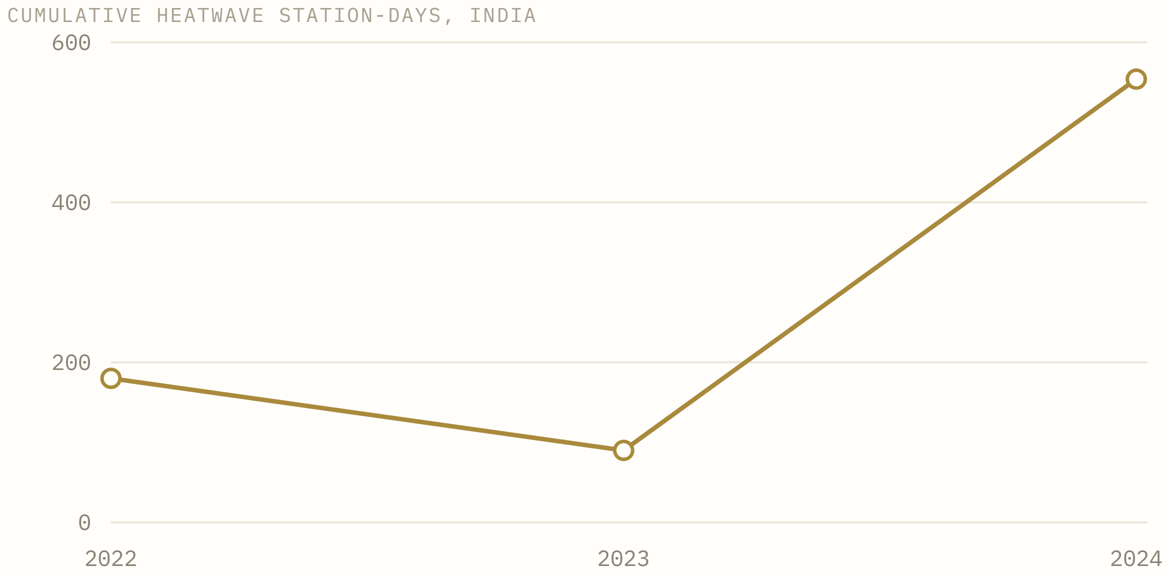
Source: India State of Forest Report, Forest Survey of India Coverage: 1987–2023 Updated: 17 Aug 2026

FIGURE 4.4 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.4 LINE CHART

Heatwave intensity, national

Cumulative heatwave station-days recorded across India's weather station network, by year.



2024 was the most intense heatwave year in over a decade. A "station-day" counts once for every IMD station crossing the heatwave threshold on a given day, so it reflects both duration and geographic spread — not a literal count of days with a heatwave somewhere.

Source: India Meteorological Department, Statement on Climate of India

2024 was widely reported as India's most intense heatwave year in over a decade, with several cities recording temperatures above 45°C. The station-day metric rewards both longer heatwaves and wider geographic spread, so a single very hot, very long event in a densely monitored region can dominate the national total.

Source: India Meteorological Department, Statement on Climate of India Coverage: 2022–2024

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

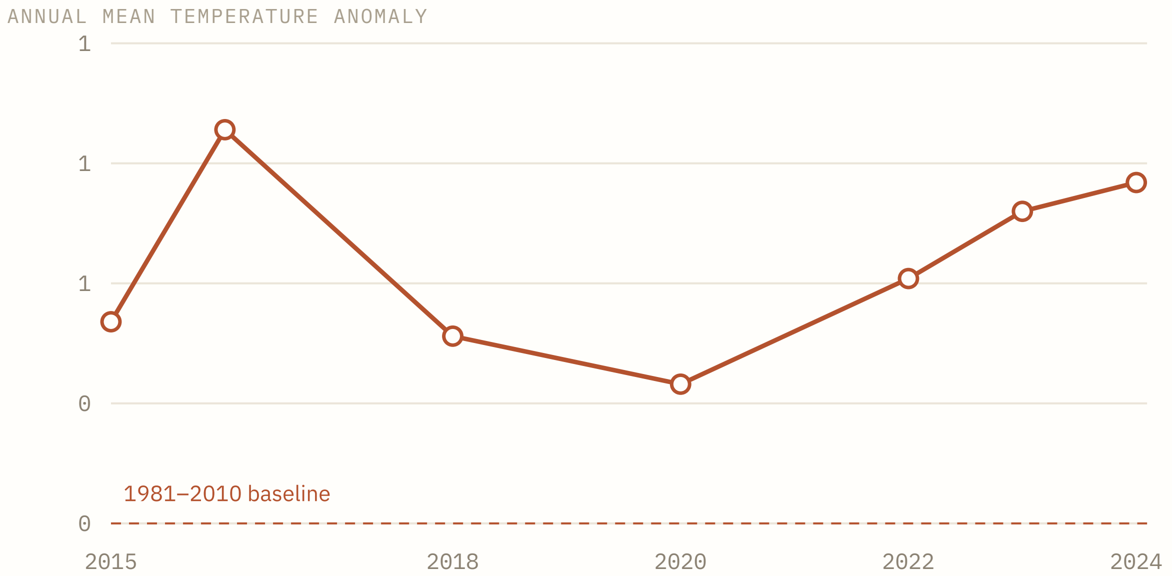
FIGURE 4.5 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.5

LINE CHART

Annual mean temperature anomaly

India’s annual mean temperature relative to the 1981–2010 average.



Departure from the 1981–2010 average. 2024 and 2016 rank among India’s warmest years on record since 1901 — year-to-year swings are large, but the underlying trend across decades is upward.

Source: India Meteorological Department, Statement on Climate of India

IMD has ranked several recent years among the warmest since national records began in 1901. Annual figures are noisy year to year — a single cool year does not reverse the multi-decade warming trend visible in the underlying data.

Source: India Meteorological Department, Statement on Climate of India Coverage: 2015–2024

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

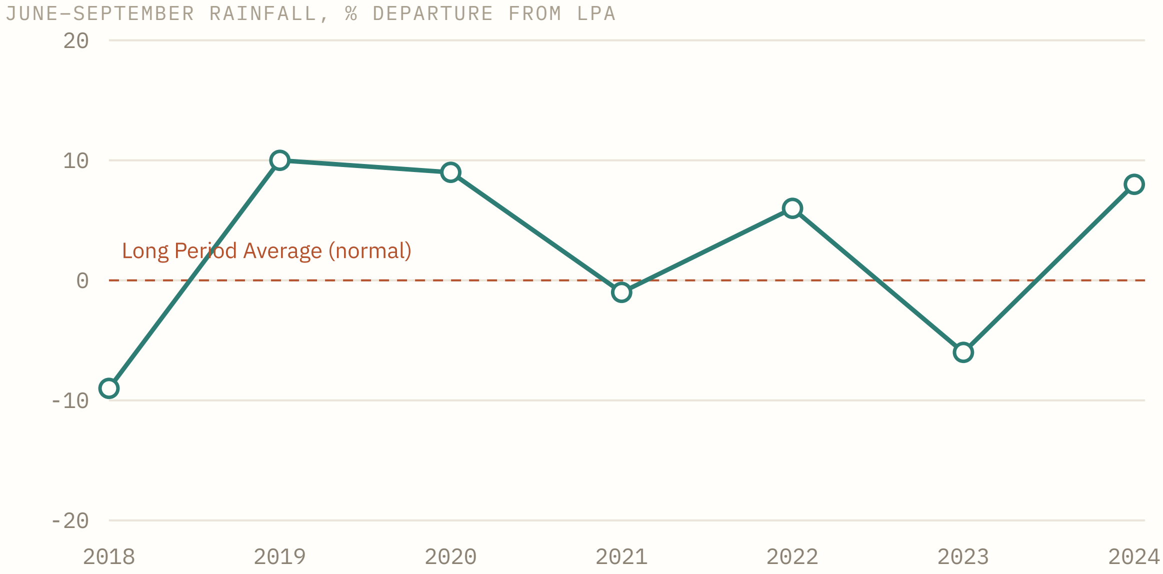
FIGURE 4.6 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.6

LINE CHART

Southwest monsoon rainfall

June–September monsoon rainfall, national, as a percentage departure from the 1971–2020 Long Period Average.



> The southwest monsoon delivers roughly 70% of India's annual rainfall and drives foodgrain output more than any other single climate variable. ±10% of the Long Period Average is classed "normal" by IMD; India has swung between deficient and excess years with no clear directional trend.

Source: India Meteorological Department

IMD classes ±10% of the LPA as "normal." The monsoon's national total can mask sharply uneven regional distribution — a "normal" year on paper can still combine drought in one region with flooding in another.

Source: India Meteorological Department Coverage: 2018–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

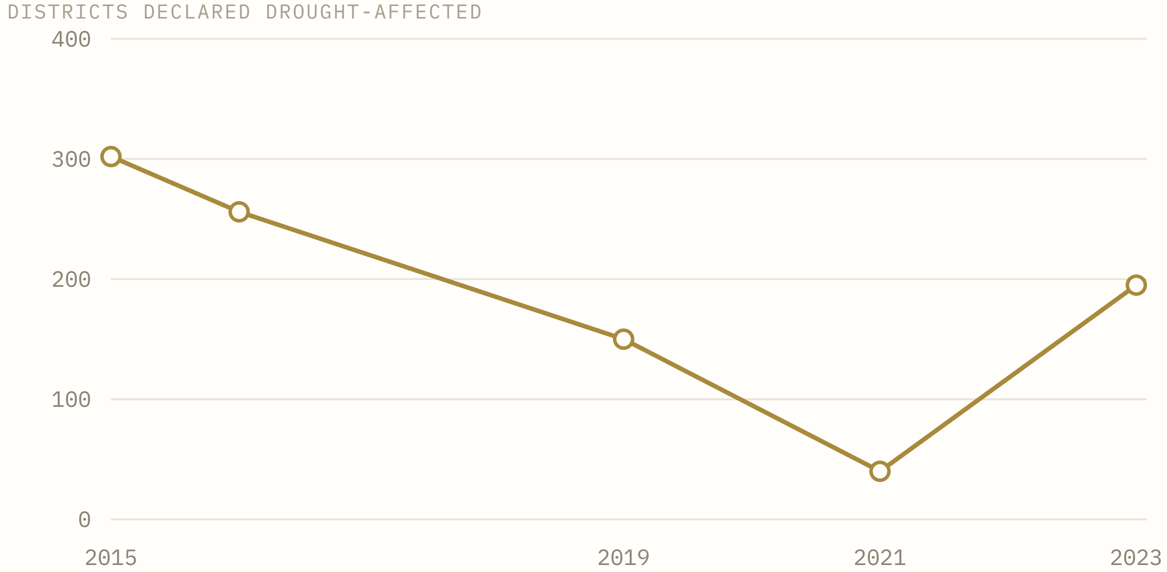
FIGURE 4.7 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.7

LINE CHART

Drought-affected districts

Districts formally declared drought-affected by state governments, by year.



> Compiled from individual state drought declarations rather than one centralised national series — states apply somewhat different thresholds under the Manual for Drought Management, so year-to-year counts should be read as broadly indicative rather than strictly comparable.

Source: State drought declarations, compiled per the Manual for Drought Management

There is no single centralised national drought register — this compiles individual state declarations, which apply the Manual for Drought Management's criteria with some local discretion. Treat trends as broadly indicative; exact counts vary by source and reporting date.

Source: State drought declarations, compiled per the Manual for Drought Management Coverage: 2015–2023

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

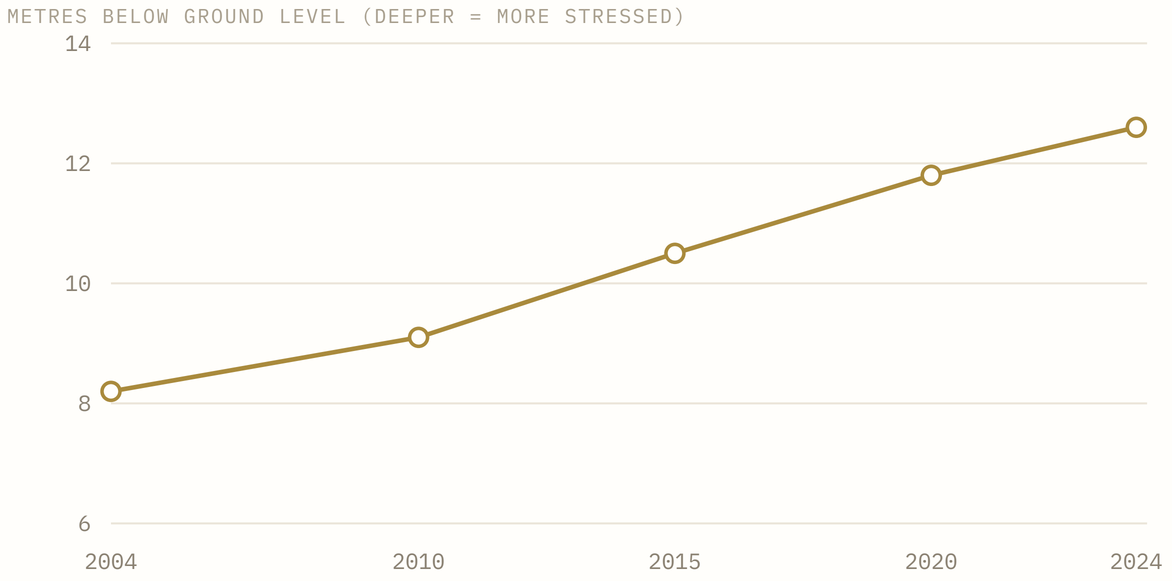
FIGURE 4.8 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.8

LINE CHART

Groundwater depletion

National average depth to groundwater level; deeper means more water-stressed.



> A national average masks enormous regional variation — parts of Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan are far more stressed than this line suggests, while parts of the Northeast and eastern India show stable or rising water tables. Read this as a national headline only, not a substitute for CGWB's block-level assessments.

Source: Central Ground Water Board (CGWB)

India is the world's largest extractor of groundwater, used mainly for irrigation. A national average conceals sharp regional divergence — Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan are critically over-extracted, while parts of eastern India show stable or even rising water tables.

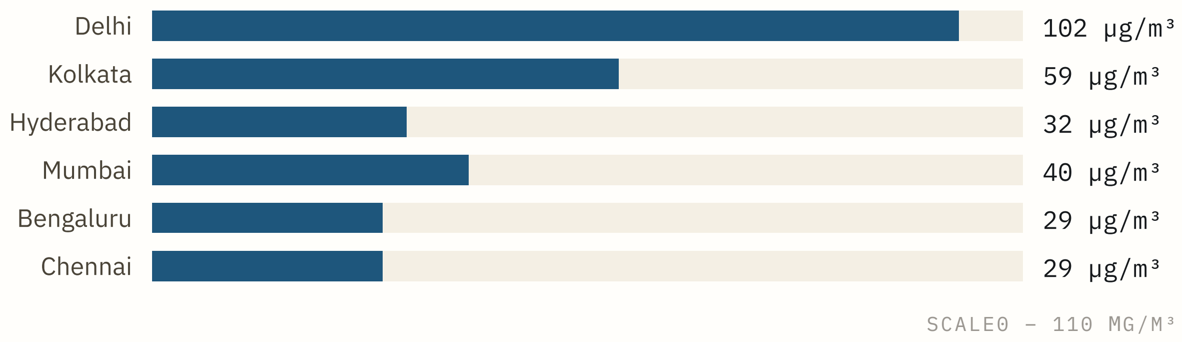
Source: Central Ground Water Board (CGWB) Coverage: 2004–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 4.9 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.9 RANKED BARS

PM2.5 across Indian cities

Annual mean PM2.5 concentration in major Indian cities.



Source: CPCB National Air Quality Monitoring Programme

Every city shown exceeds both the WHO guideline (5 µg/m³) and India's own national standard (40 µg/m³). Delhi's winter inversion and regional stubble-burning make its annual average an outlier even among India's other large, heavily polluted cities.

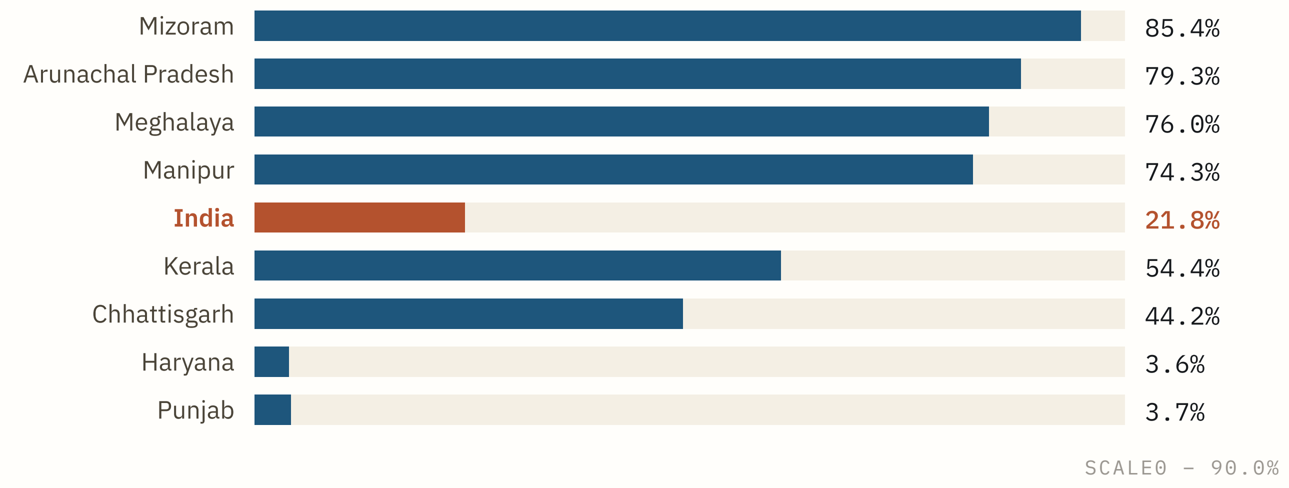
Source: CPCB National Air Quality Monitoring Programme Coverage: 2023 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 4.10 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 4.10 RANKED BARS

Forest cover by state

Forest cover as a share of geographic area, by state, 2023 assessment.



Source: India State of Forest Report, Forest Survey of India

The gap between India’s most and least forested major states spans more than 80 percentage points. Northeastern states carry a hugely disproportionate share of India’s forest cover relative to their land area’s share of the country.

> Highest: **Mizoram** at 85.4%. Lowest: **Haryana** at 3.6%.

Source: India State of Forest Report, Forest Survey of India Coverage: 2023 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

CHAPTER 5

Energy & electricity

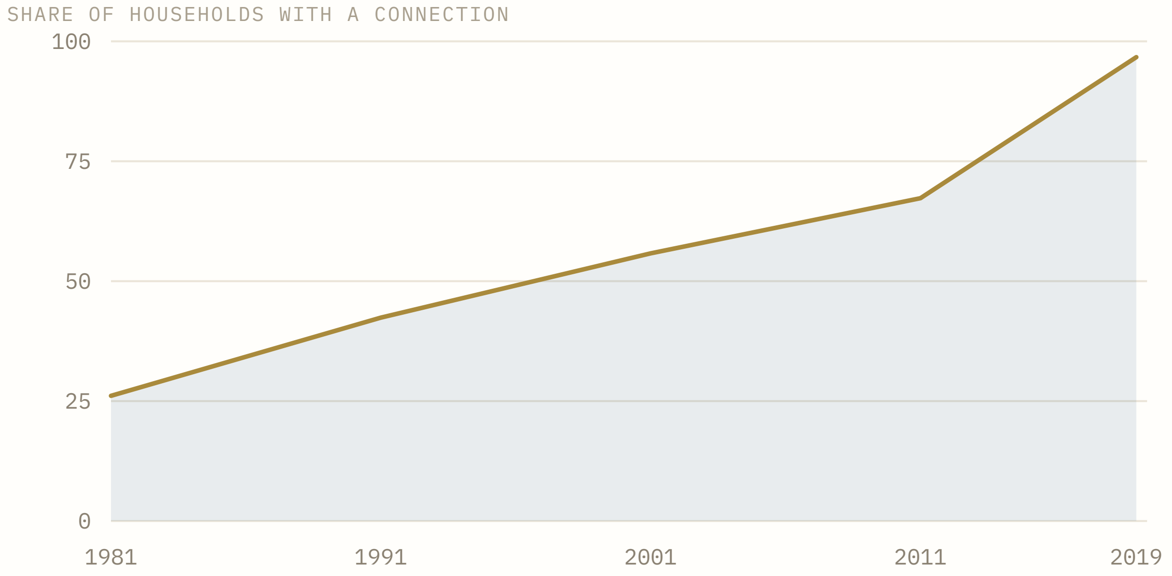
2 of 5 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 5.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 5.1 AREA CHART

Household electricity access

Share of households with an electricity connection.



> Census figures to 2011; the 2019 point is the Saubhagya administrative count of electrified households, which measures connection rather than hours of supply.

Source: Census of India; Saubhagya dashboard, Ministry of Power

Connection is not the same as supply. Administrative data reports near-universal connection since 2019, but survey data on hours of supply shows large rural shortfalls, especially in Bihar, Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh.

Source: Census of India; Saubhagya dashboard, Ministry of Power Coverage: 1981–2023 Updated: 30 May 2026

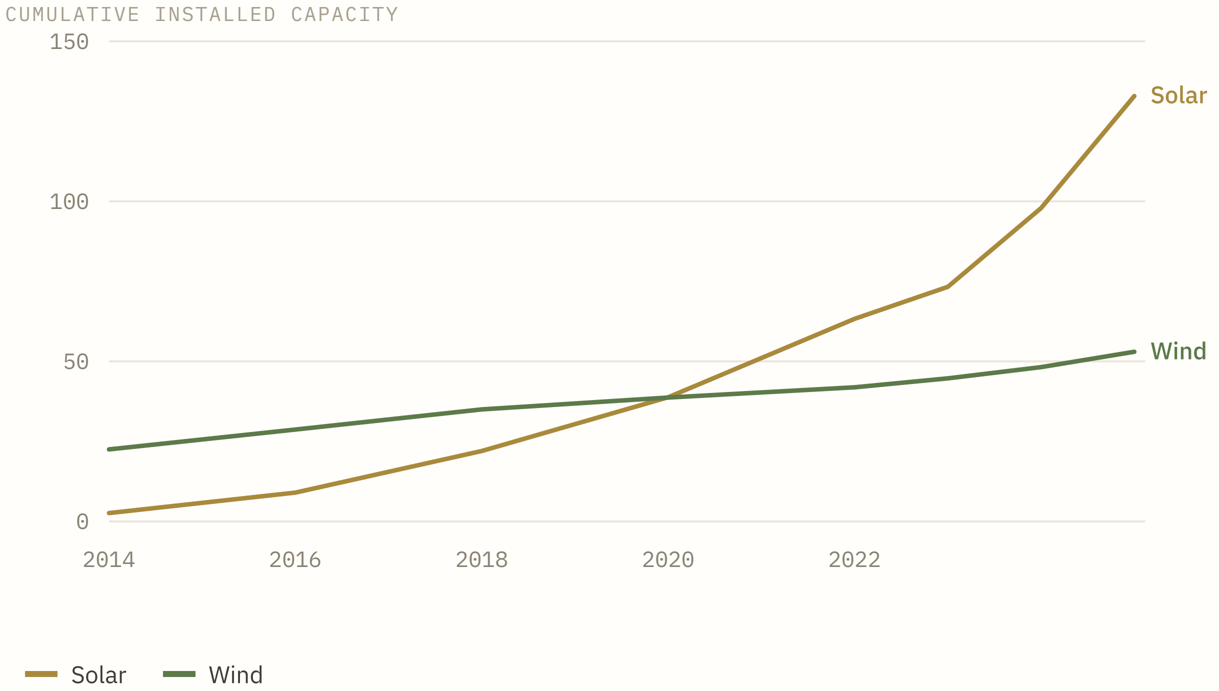
FIGURE 5.2 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 5.2

LINE CHART

Installed solar and wind capacity

Grid-connected capacity in gigawatts.



> Capacity, not generation. Indian solar runs at roughly a 17–21 % capacity factor and wind 20–26 %, so a gigawatt of either delivers far less energy than a gigawatt of coal.

Source: MNRE Physical Progress Report, Nov 2025

Capacity is not generation. Solar capacity factors in India run 17–21 per cent, wind 20–26 per cent, so a gigawatt of each delivers far less energy than a gigawatt of coal. Both series are ahead of the trajectory implied by the 2015 targets.

Source: MNRE Physical Progress Report, Nov 2025 Coverage: 2014–2025 Updated: 30 May 2026

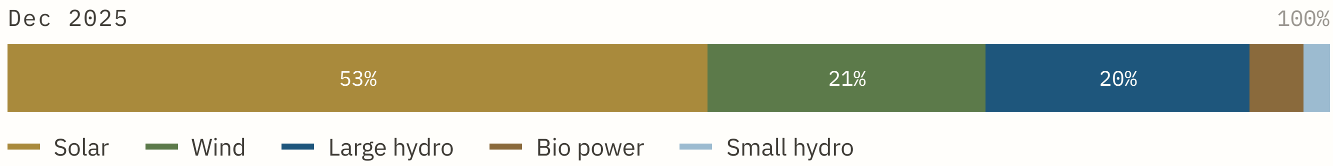
FIGURE 5.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 5.3

COMPOSITION

Renewable capacity by source

Composition of roughly 258 GW of installed renewable capacity.



Share of India’s ~258 GW of renewable capacity by source. Solar passed half of the renewable fleet during 2025.

Source: MNRE; CEA installed capacity reports

Solar passed half the renewable fleet during 2025. Large hydro, which took seven decades to build, is now smaller than solar, which took eleven years.

Source: MNRE; CEA installed capacity reports Coverage: Dec 2025 Updated: 30 May 2026

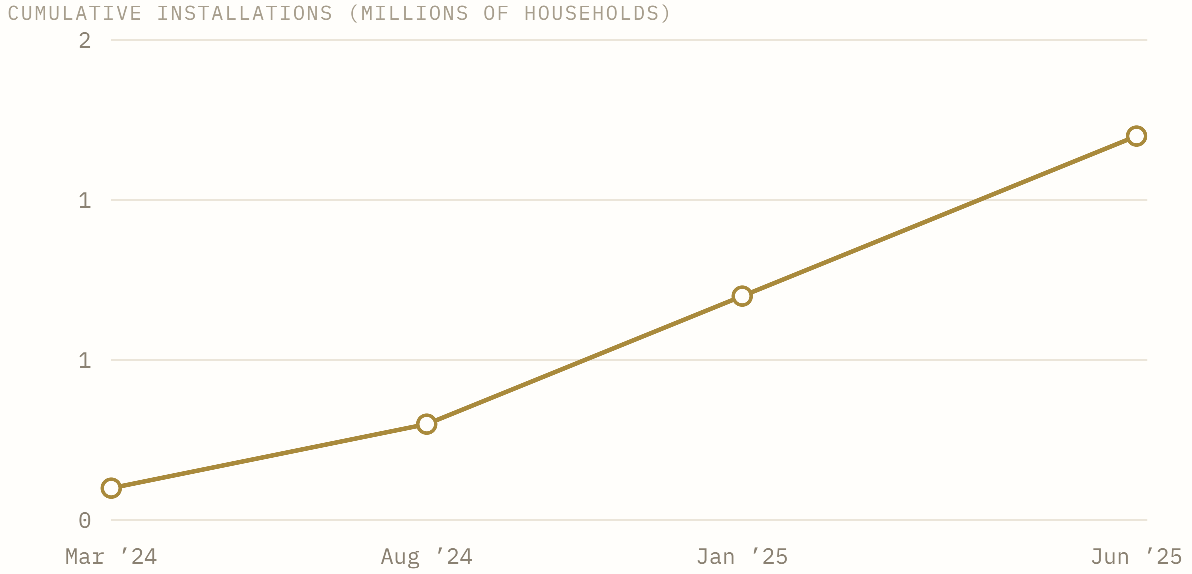
FIGURE 5.4 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 5.4

LINE CHART

PM Surya Ghar rooftop solar adoption

Cumulative households with rooftop solar installed under the scheme since its February 2024 launch.



PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana launched in February 2024 targeting 10 million rooftop solar households by 2027. As a young, fast-moving scheme its published figures update monthly and can move materially between editions of this chart.

Source: PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, Ministry of New & Renewable Energy

The scheme targets 10 million rooftop-solar households by 2027; adoption so far is a small fraction of that target and figures update frequently as installation data is reconciled with subsidy disbursement.

Source: PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, Ministry of New & Renewable Energy Coverage: Mar 2024–Jun 2025

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

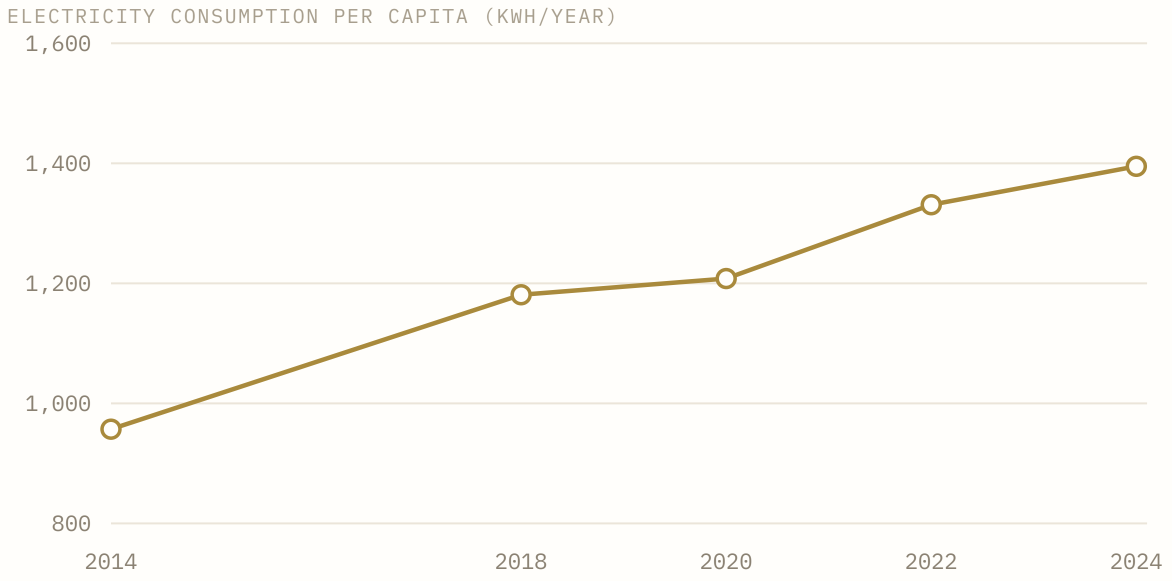
FIGURE 5.5 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 5.5

LINE CHART

Electricity consumption per capita

Per-capita electricity consumption, national average.



> India's per-capita consumption has grown roughly 46% in a decade but remains well below the world average and a fraction of consumption in China or the OECD — rising incomes and air-conditioning penetration are the main drivers ahead.

Source: Central Electricity Authority (CEA)

This is a different question from your household electricity access indicator: access asks whether a connection exists; this asks how much power the average person actually uses — a better proxy for living standards and industrial activity than connection rates alone.

Source: Central Electricity Authority (CEA) Coverage: 2014–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

Methodology and limitations

Every figure in this report is reproduced from a published source without adjustment. India Insight Lab does not estimate, model or interpolate the values shown. Each chart carries the source it came from, the years it covers and the date the series was last updated.

Three limitations apply to everything above, and are stated rather than worked around:

- **Geographic depth.** Indicators reach national and, for 8 of 36 series, state level. District and city figures are not included because comparable data is not yet integrated.
- **Comparability across sources.** Series drawn from different sources use different definitions, reference periods and sampling designs. They are shown side by side but are not adjusted onto a common basis.
- **Currency.** Update dates vary by series; the most recent revision date is shown beneath each figure. Some official series lag by several years.

> **Nothing in this report is projected.** Where a series ends, the report ends with it. No forecast, scenario or extrapolation has been added to extend a trend beyond its published data.

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Source URLs, licence terms and retrieval dates are not yet recorded for every series. Adding them is scheduled work, and until it is done these references name the publication rather than link to it.